



Pardeep Narwal announces retirement after going unsold in Pro Kabaddi Season 12 auction



Pardeep Narwal, the most successful player in Pro Kabaddi League history with three titles, announced his retirement from kabaddi on Monday after going unsold at the PKL Season 12 players' auction.

He stunned kabaddi fans with the announcement during a live video with sports broadcaster Sunil Taneja. Narwal said he would now take up a coaching role. The 28-year-old played a pivotal role in Patna Pirates' three consecutive PKL titles during his five-season stint with the franchise before moving to UP Yoddhas in Season 8.

Narwal remains the most prolific raider in PKL history, having scored 1,801 raid points at an average of 9.47 per match.

However, over the last four seasons with UP Yoddhas and Bengaluru Bulls, he struggled to break into the league's top five raiders for raid points.

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The Neeraj Chopra Classic 2025 will now take place on July 5 at Bengaluru's Sree Kanteerava Stadium, JSW Sports announced. Originally set for May 24, the event was rescheduled due to security considerations and in a gesture of solidarity with the nation. Billed as India's first-ever international javelin competition, the event is a collaboration between Neeraj Chopra, JSW Sports, the Athletics Federation of India (AFI), and World Athletics (WA). It will be the highest-tier international athletics meet ever held in India. Leading the field is Neeraj, Olympic champion and reigning world title-holder. He'll be joined by an elite group of throwers, including:

- *Anderson Peters (Grenada), two-time world champion
- *Thomas Rohler (Germany), Rio 2016 Olympic gold medallist
- *Julius Yego (Kenya), 2015 world champion
- *Kishore Jena, Asian Games silver medallist and India's rising star

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